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MINNEAPOLIS — When Neil Chrisley told Manager Andy Cohen that he was ready to play, he meant it.

And when the new Indianapolis outfielder proved it last night by whacking a single, triple and home run to drive in four runs during a 5-4 Tribe victory, Minneapolis General Manager Rosy Ryan must have groaned.



Koelling

Ryan, it is understood, was after Washington all during spring training to option Chrisley to Minneapolis. He even made several trips to Washington's training base at Orlando, Fla., in attempts to get the hard-hitting outfielder.

But Indianapolis had a bid in, too, and the fact that the Chicago White Sox could help Washington's Chattanooga club with Double A players, sent Chrisley to Indianapolis. Manager Cohen plans to "platoon" Chrisley and Sam Mele, which means the latter will be in the lineup tonight when Pete Burnside, a southpaw, meets Jim McDonald in the second game of the series.

The victory last night, the second straight close-shave verdict, was the Tribe's fourth straight and put the club over the .500 mark for the first time this season. The defeat was only the sixth suffered by the Millers at home in 22 games.

The Indians now hold two victories over the Millers in four games and both have been credited to Barry Latman. However, the young right-hander missed turning in the club's fourth straight full-route pitching performance when he fell into sin in the ninth inning.

Latman's fifth walk, followed by a single with none out, prompted Manager Cohen to renew acquaintances with the bullpen buddies. First it was George Spencer, who was touched for a sacrifice bunt, a walk and a sacrifice fly for one run, and finally it was Tom Flanigan, the lefty, who slipped over a called third strike on Bill Taylor, who had homered on his previous trip.

Thus the Indians won their ninth one-run verdict against four defeats and Minneapolis took its sixth one-run loss against 10 victories. The Indianapolis victory also ended a four-game Minneapolis winning streak and temporarily,